

Architectural styles

BAROQUE AND ROCOCO

Characterized by the effects of illusion and drama, the Baroque emerged in the 17th century as a manifestation of the spirit of the Counter-Reformation. Originating in Italy, it spread through Europe, followed by its variant form, Rococo.

The origins of Baroque are closely bound up with the doctrines of the Counter-Reformation. Emerging in response to the Protestant Reformation of the 16th century, the Counter-Reformation sought to reaffirm the principles of the Catholic faith, which the Protestants had challenged. Art and architecture became vital tools in this process, with a number of church commissions used as opportunities to express the Catholic Church's power. Architects such as Bernini, Borromini, and Guarini deployed bold forms, sweeping curves, and dramatic effects of light and shade to create buildings of amazing power and drama.

As Baroque spread over Europe, local variations emerged. Although it had originated in the context of ecclesiastical architecture, Baroque was often used in palace architecture, where it functioned more broadly as an architecture of power. And it was in this context that it developed into Rococo in the 18th century.



dedicatory inscription along frieze

△ CURVED ENTABLATURE

While still depending on the Classical language for its architectural vocabulary, Baroque exaggerates its forms and proportions. One of the most recognizable examples is the way a straight entablature might be transformed into a concave or convex curving surface.

The word **Baroque** derives from the Portuguese for a **misshapen pearl**

STATUES, DECORATION, AND STAIRCASES

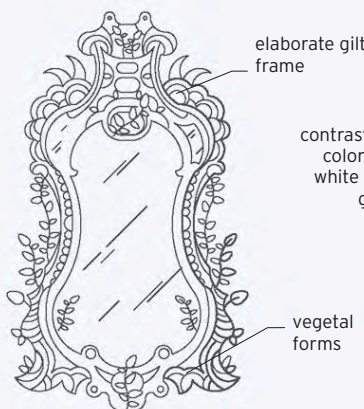


cherubs are often shown playing musical instruments

sculptures appear as if in motion

△ CHERUBS

A cherub or *putto* is a small winged, usually quite chubby, boy, frequently found in scenes of the divine in Baroque art and architecture.



elaborate gilt frame

contrasting colors of white and gray

vegetal forms

△ ORNATE MIRRORS

Rococo is an interior architecture style in which the forms of Classical architecture are subsumed into an almost abstract decorative language.



eye-catching, theatrical staircase

△ TIERED EXTERNAL STAIRS

The tiered staircase is a key example of the layering, bold ornamentation, and intersecting volumes that characterize Baroque.

building stands on trapezoidal plot of land

elliptical cellar windows

pilasters ornament exposed side of building

cross of the Trinitarian order displayed prominently in center of facade

dome has no drum, but rests directly on cornice